

Tinamou

PHYLUM	Chordata
CLASS	Aves
ORDER	Tinamiformes
FAMILIES	1 (Tinamidae)
SPECIES	47

These ground-living birds, which look similar to grouse and partridges, have a plump body and small wings. When running or flying, they tire easily because they have a small heart relative to their size. Tinamous are common in woodland, scrub, and grassland throughout Central and South America.

CAMOUFLAGE
When threatened, this Andean tinamou remains motionless, protected by its excellent camouflage.



Eudromia elegans

Elegant crested tinamou



Height	14½–16 in (37–41 cm)
Weight	14–29 oz (400–800 g)
Plumage	Sexes alike
Migration	Nonmigrant
Status	Least concern

Location S. South America



The long, usually forward-curving crest is the distinguishing feature of this tinamou. Light to dark brown, the elegant crested tinamou has wings that are spotted white. One light

stripe runs behind the eye, and another runs below it. This relatively shy bird usually moves in small to moderately large groups through woodland, grassland, and brush.



Ostrich

PHYLUM	Chordata
CLASS	Aves
ORDER	Struthioniformes
FAMILIES	1 (Struthionidae)
SPECIES	2

The largest of all birds, ostriches are unmistakable in appearance. They have a long, bare neck and small head, a massive body, and long, muscular legs. The wings are small and covered with loosely packed feathers. Ostriches are unique among birds in having only 2 toes on each foot. Although too heavy to fly, they are capable of running with remarkable speed and stamina—they can travel up to 45mph (70kph) for as long as 30 minutes. There are two species of ostriches, Common and Somali.

FIGHTING MALES
Male ostriches compete for territory and social status with aggressive displays and occasionally by fighting. The winner of a contest acquires a territory and several females, although only one female, the "major hen," remains during incubation and chick-rearing.



Struthio camelus

Common ostrich



Height	7–9¼ft (2.1–2.8 m)
Weight	220–350 lb (100–160 kg)
Plumage	Sexes differ
Migration	Nonmigrant
Status	Least concern

Location W. to E. Africa (south of Sahara), southern Africa



Once widespread in Africa and West Asia, ostriches are now restricted largely to eastern and southern Africa, although they are also farmed in other parts of the world. In the wild, they are seminomadic, traveling long distances to find grass and other plant food. They typically form mixed-sex herds, and are rarely found on their own. During the breeding season, males make loud, booming calls and perform elaborate displays. Several females often lay in a single nest, producing a joint clutch of up to 30 eggs. The male takes part in incubation; once the eggs hatch—after about 40 days—he is usually in sole charge of the young.

